

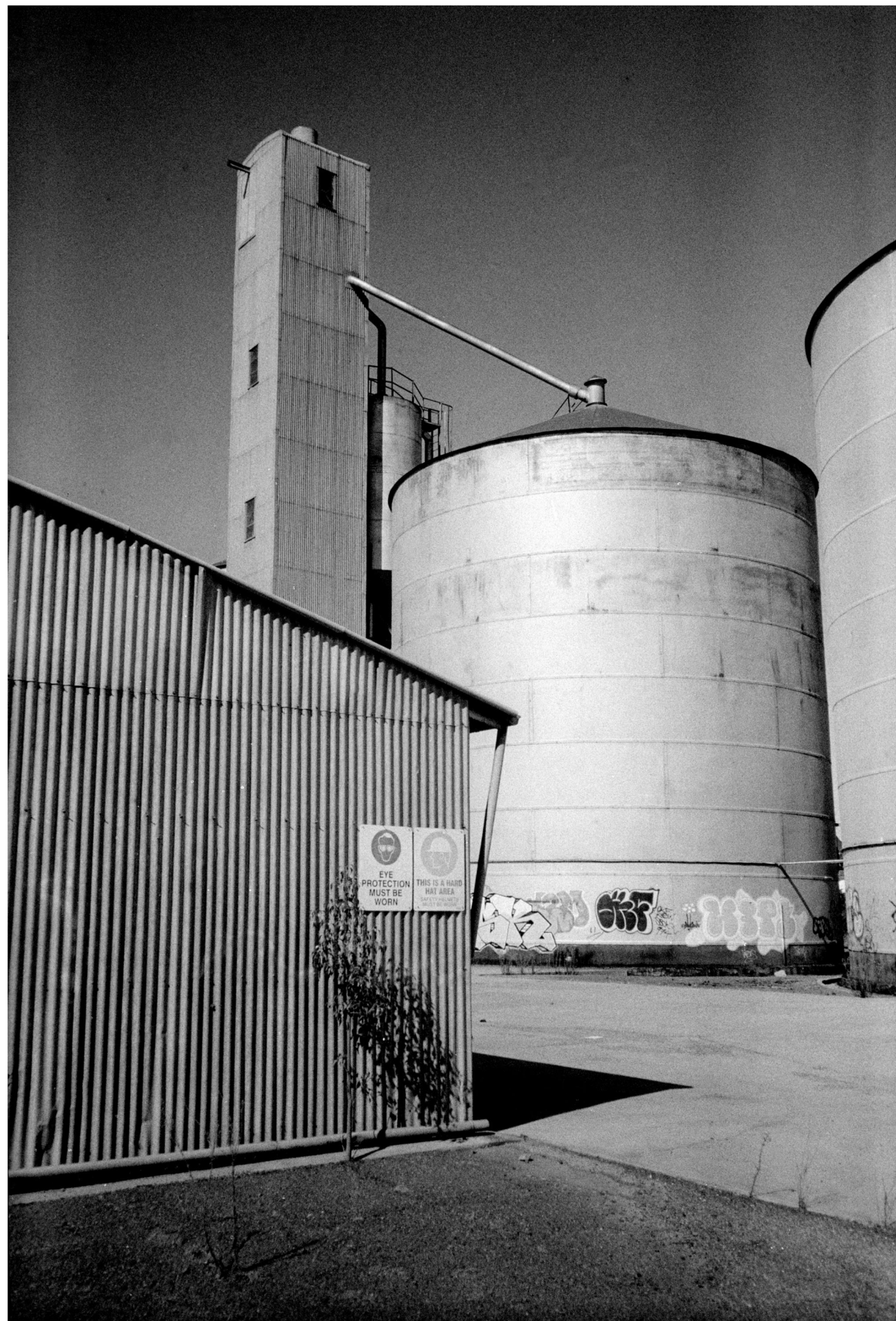


50

EARLY MARCH 2026
Diesel \$1.85/Litre

FLAT STICK is a zine documenting my trip around Australia. All photos are mine, taken on 35mm film & developed in the van.

P.S.A → Please do not take photos whilst driving, its dangerous & illegal, the cover photo was taken by a trained professional.





Welcome,

Its been a while since my last Zine & here we are. I've decided to hit the road & travel Australia once more, this time in a Van. There is no plan & thats the beauty of it, this zine will be my way of documenting the journey please come along for the ride.

love Jared ^{xx}

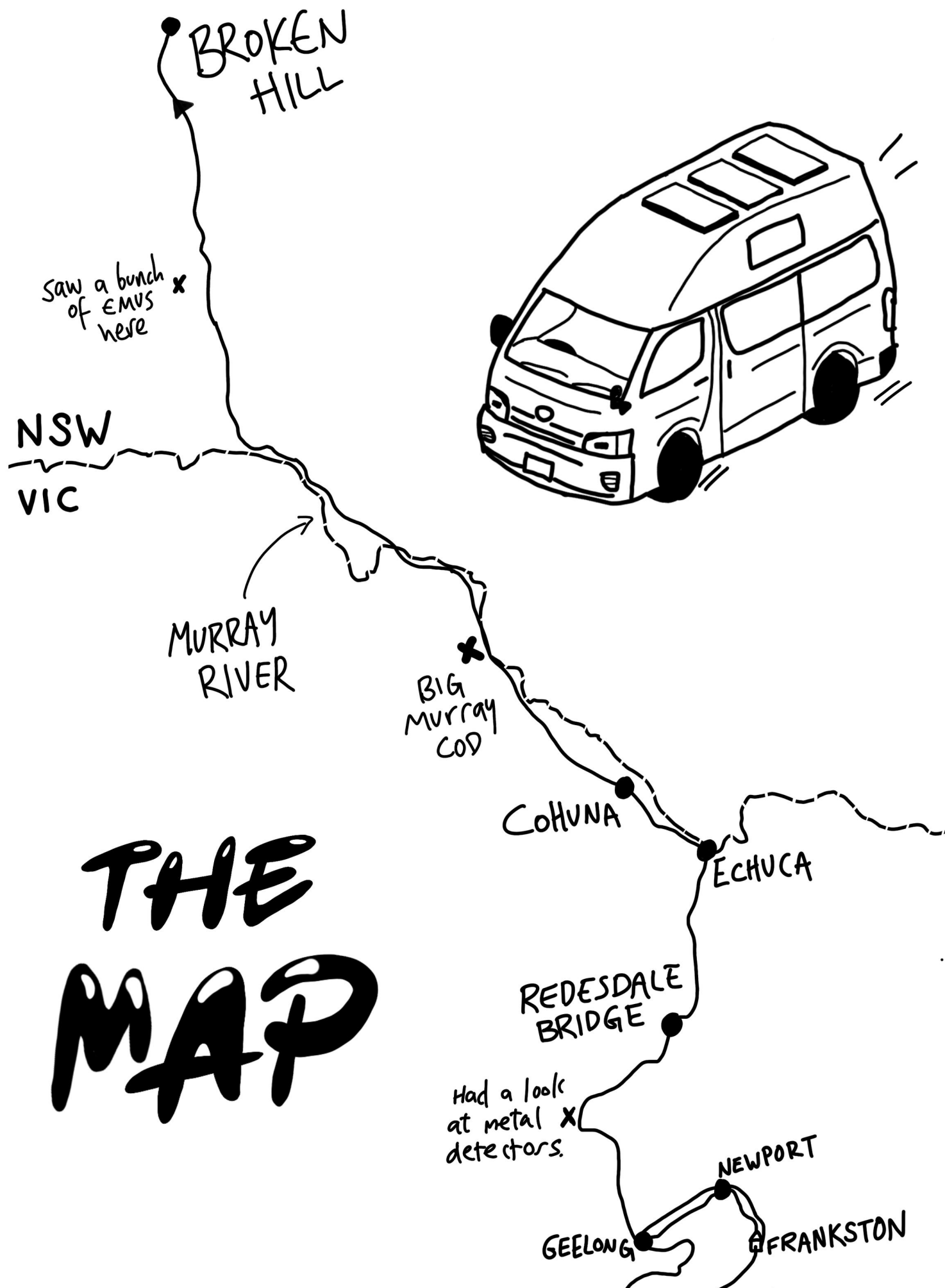
P.S. A big thanks to Trevor for giving me the push I needed, to get pen to paper.

ECHUCA

I slept out the front of the Mechanic, dropped the keys in at 9am, took my bike off the back & rode into town. I didn't know much about Echuca, just the MURRAY & steamboats, so I headed there. It has part of the original port high up above the river, ready with cranes to transfer produce to a train & down to Melbourne, Echuca being the closest point the Murray is to Melbourne. I watched a few paddle steamers come & go & talked to a man about how steam engines work.

I wandered down the main drag, bought a stick of fudge & ducked into the '2nd hand book store'. I found some old comics in a pile "The Fabulous Furry Freak Brothers" & "Fat Freddy's Cat" they were 1970s/1980s part of the San Francisco underground comix scene. I had seen the Harvey Crumb doco & always been interested. I got a couple & sat on a bench to have a read, they were hilarious, a little dated but enjoyable. I looked them up online & saw issue #1 goes for \$500! I swear had seen that issue in the shop.

I pedalled like mad & rode back, I bought the whole lot on the cheap! Turns out they did reprints & my issue #1 is liked reprint 12 haha oh well at least I have a load of comics to read.



OH WHAT A



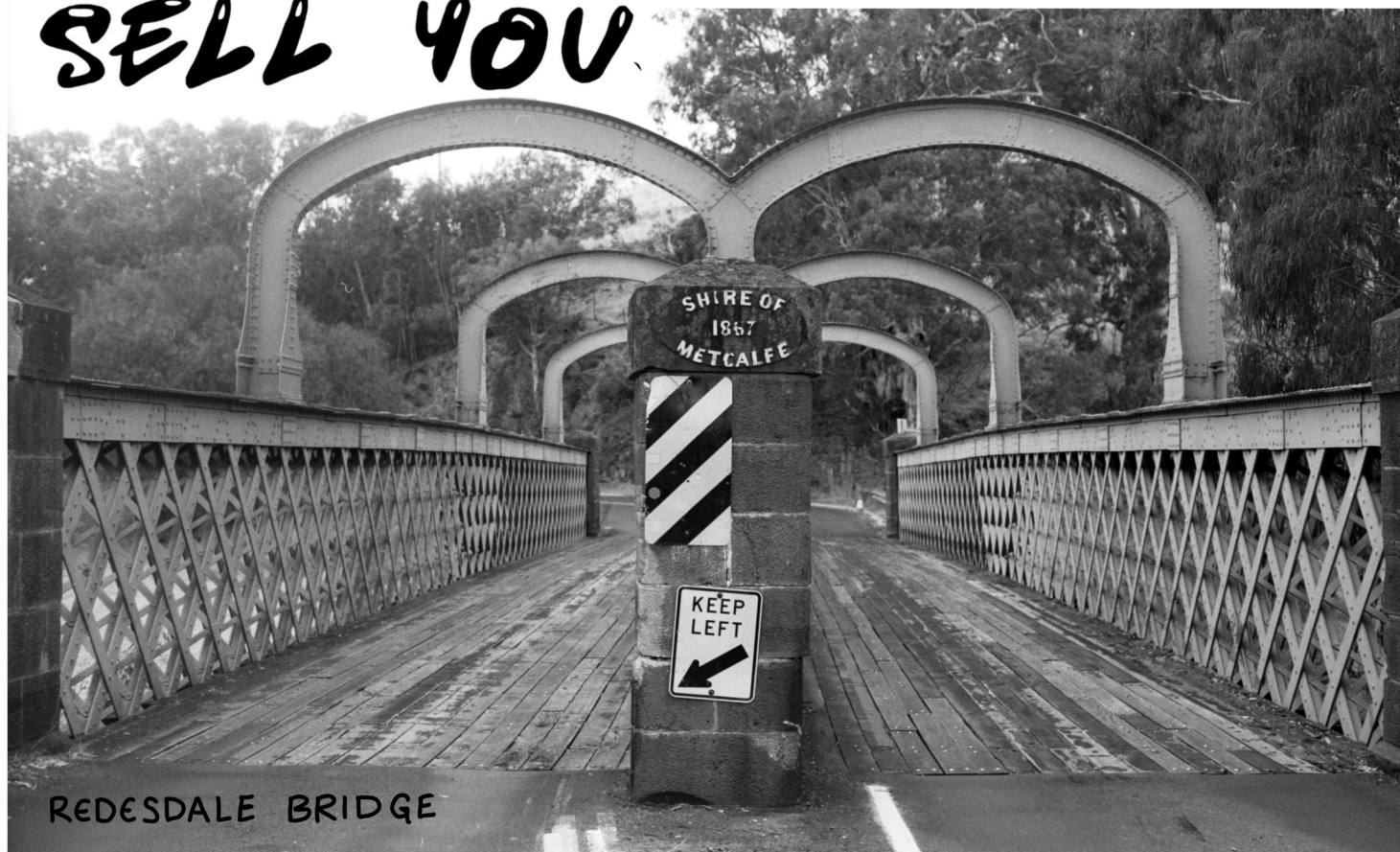
FEELING!

OIL CRISIS



As I left Melbourne I drove through Newport & saw one of the large fuel silos being destroyed. Foreshadowing what was to come because later that night I watched as Israel & the US bombed IRAN. The next time I stopped for fuel there was cars all lined up. Just my luck I set off to drive around Australia, in a DIESEL, and the next oil crisis begins. I'll have to cut back otherwise its going to be a short trip.

I HAVE A BRIDGE TO SELL YOU.



REDESDALE BRIDGE

On this trip (& in life) I like to play it by ear, no set plan & the above is why. On a backroad out of KYNEDON I stumbled across this beautiful unique bridge with an even more unique history.

The trusses were originally made & shipped to Melbourne for the HAWTHORN BRIDGE, over the YARRA (near IKEA) however the ship 'Herald of the Morning' carrying them caught fire & sank in Hobsons Bay. As a result new trusses were built & sent, Hawthorn Bridge was delayed several years & ended up with a new design.

10 years later the wreck of the Herald of the Morning was salvaged & the trusses were sold to the goldfield shires of McIVOR & Metcalfe. who built the bridge above.



COHUNA

I booked my van in for a service in Echuca & I had a 3 days to burn until they could fit me in. A quick search brought up Cohuna just up the road & it had free RV camping for 3 days! Perfect! When stuff like this happens you know it's meant to be.

The first thing you see is the water tower & it's quite the tower, very tall, with Cohuna painted on it. Water was definitely the theme whilst I was there.

The RV park was actually on an island, the largest inland island in Australia. It's called Gunbower Island, it is surrounded by the MURRAY RIVER & Gunbower Creek. The creek was beautiful & teeming with wildlife, there also was an irrigation channel funneling off. In the morning I collected cans & bottles to help fund the trip & pay for diesel. I got some books at the antique store & a nice burger from the servo. It is a really beautiful little town really left me in a great mood.

